divided over PS and SB (keeping in mind that different parts of the hull may be treated with different anti-fouling systems);

- triplicate specimens of paint at each sampling point should be taken in close proximity to each other on the hull (e.g., within 10 cm of each other);

- contamination of the samples should be avoided, which normally includes the wearing of non-sterilized non-powdered disposable gloves of suitable impervious material e.g., nitrile rubber;

- the samples should be collected and stored in an inert container (e.g., containers should not consist of materials containing organotins or have the capacity to absorb organotins);

- samples should be taken from an area where the surface of the anti-fouling system is intact, clean and free of fouling;

- loose paint chips coming from detached, peeled or blistered hull areas should not be used for sampling;

- samples should not be taken from a heated or area where the paint is otherwise softened (e.g., heavy fuel tanks); and

- the underlying layers (primers, sealers, TBT containing AFS) should not be

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not be used for sampling;

- samples should not be taken from a heated or area where the paint is otherwise softened (e.g., heavy fuel tanks); and

- the underlying layers (primers, sealers, TBT containing AFS) should not be sampled if there is no clear evidence of exposure of extended areas.

2 Validity of the sampling

In order to safeguard the validity of the sampling as evidence of non-compliance, the following should be considered:

- only samples taken directly from the hull and free of possible contamination should be used;

- all samples should be stored in containers, marked and annotated on the record sheet. This record sheet should be submitted to the Administration;

- the receipts identifying the persons having custody and receiving transfer of the samples should be filled in and accompany the samples to reflect the transfer chain of the samples;

- the PSCO should verify the validity of the instrument's calibration validity date

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the samples should be filled in and accompany the samples to reflect the transfer chain of the samples;

- the PSCO should verify the validity of the instrument's calibration validity date (according to the manufacturer instruction);

- in cases when a contracted specialist company is used for carrying out sampling, the PSCO should accompany its representative to verify sampling; and

- photographs of the hull, sample areas and sampling process could serve as additional proof.

It is also the case that sampling companies and/or procedures can be certified.

3 Health and safety when sampling

Any obligation to take a sample should be subject to practical feasibility or any constraints relating to the safety of persons, the ship or the port.

The PSCO is advised to ensure their safety taking the following points into account:

- general requirements enforced by the terminal or port authority and national health, safety and environmental policy;

- condition of the ship (ballast condition, ship's operations, mooring, anchorage, etc.);

- surroundings (position of ship, traffic, ships movement, quay operations, barges or other floating vessels alongside);

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- condition of the ship (ballast condition, ship's operations, mooring, anchorage, etc.);

- surroundings (position of ship, traffic, ships movement, quay operations, barges or other floating vessels alongside);

- safety measures for the use of access equipment (platforms, cherry picker, staging, ladders, railings, climbing harness, etc.), e.g., ISO 18001;

- weather (sea state, wind, rain, temperature, etc.); and

- precautions to avoid falling into the water between the quay and the ship. If in doubt, a lifejacket and if possible a safety line, should be worn when sampling.

Any adverse situation encountered during sampling that could endanger the safety of personnel, shall be reported to the safety coordinator.

Care should be taken to avoid contact of the removed paint with the skin and the eyes, and no particles should be swallowed or come into contact with foodstuffs. Eating or drinking during sampling is prohibited and hands should be cleaned afterwards. Persons carrying out sampling should be aware that the AFS and solvents or other materials used for sampling

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during sampling is prohibited and hands should be cleaned afterwards. Persons carrying out sampling should be aware that the AFS and solvents or other materials used for sampling may be harmful and appropriate precautions should be taken. Personal protection should be considered by using long sleeve solvent-resistant gloves, dust mask, safety glasses, etc.

Standard (and specific, if applicable) laboratory safety procedures should be followed at all times when undertaking the sampling procedures and subsequent analysis.

4 Conducting analyses

The Guidelines for brief sampling of anti-fouling systems on ships envisage a two-stage analysis of samples for both methods presented in the appendix to the Guidelines. The first stage is a basic test, which can be carried out on site as in the case of Method 2. The second stage is carried out when the first stage results are positive. It is noted that in the

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first stage is a basic test, which can be carried out on site as in the case of Method 2. The second stage is carried out when the first stage results are positive. It is noted that in the IMO Guidelines, these stages are referred to as Steps 1 and 2 as in the case of Method 1. It is to the discretion of the port State competent authorities to choose which analysis methods are used.

The following points are presented for port State consideration:

- approval procedure for the recognition of laboratories meeting ISO 17025 standards or other appropriate facilities should be set up by the port State competent authorities. These procedures should define the recognition criteria. Exchange of information between port States on these procedures, criteria and laboratories/facilities would be beneficial, i.e. for the purposes of exchange of best practices and possible cross-border recognition and provision of services;

- the company that undertakes the analysis and/or samples should comply with national regulations and be independent from paint manufacturers;

- the PSCO carrying out the AFS inspection of a ship should verify the validity of

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- the company that undertakes the analysis and/or samples should comply with national regulations and be independent from paint manufacturers;

- the PSCO carrying out the AFS inspection of a ship should verify the validity of the ISO 17025 certificate and/or the recognition of the laboratory;

- if more time is needed for analysis than available considering the ship's scheduled time of departure, the PSCO shall inform the ship and report the situation to the port State competent authority. However, the time needed for analysis does not warrant undue delay of the ship; and

- PSCOs should ensure completion of the record sheets for the sampling procedure as proof of analysis. In cases when the laboratory procedures prescribe presentation of the analyses' results in a different format, this